

LinkedIn Search Methodology

Keywords & hashtags used to find USA university PhD postings

This document accompanies **USA_University_PhD_LinkedIn_Postings.xlsx**. It lists the exact search phrases entered into LinkedIn's content search (via [linkedin.com/search/results/content/?keywords=...](https://www.linkedin.com/search/results/content/?keywords=...)) to surface the 50 postings in that file, plus the hashtags observed on relevant posts that make similar content easy to re-find in future searches.

1. Search Queries Used

Nine phrase-based queries were run in sequence. Quoted phrases force LinkedIn to match that exact wording; unquoted words are treated as additional filter terms. Broader queries surfaced aggregator/shared posts, while precise phrases mimicking how professors actually word recruitment posts surfaced the richest, most detailed results (contact emails, deadlines, specific lab focus).

1. "PhD position" university

Broad

Broad discovery query. Caught shared/aggregator posts (e.g., PhD position boards, RAs sharing openings) across many universities and disciplines.

2. "seeking PhD students" lab

High-yield

Targeted the exact phrase professors commonly use when recruiting into their own lab. High precision, good detail (lab name, research focus).

3. "PhD in business" OR "doctoral program" business school

Category-specific

Covered MBA/Business PhD programs specifically, using an OR to catch both common phrasings.

4. "PhD program" "business school" applications now open

Category-specific

Found business-school posts actively announcing open application windows.

5. "join my lab" PhD 2027

High-yield

Caught individual professors personally recruiting for their lab, with an intake-year filter to bias toward current/upcoming openings.

6. "PhD in Finance" OR "PhD in Marketing" applications

Category-specific

Sub-field-specific query for business PhD concentrations not always tagged generically as "business".

7. "recruiting PhD students" lab

High-yield

Near-duplicate of the "seeking PhD students" phrasing to catch professors who worded it differently. Also high precision.

8. "PhD student" "my lab" machine learning 2027

Field + High-yield

Narrowed to CS/ML lab openings with a specific intake year to bias toward fresh postings.

9. "PhD student" "computer science" lab recruiting

High-yield

General CS-lab recruiting phrase; caught postings that did not use "seeking"/"recruiting" as the lead verb.

Tag key: **High-yield** = precise phrasing matching how professors naturally word recruitment posts, consistently returned the most usable/detailed results. **Broad** = wide net, more noise but good initial coverage. **Category-specific** = aimed specifically at MBA/Business PhD content. **Field** = narrowed to a specific discipline (e.g., machine learning).

2. Filtering Applied After Search

LinkedIn's content search has no true full-text relevance tuning or custom date-range filter, so every result returned by the queries above was manually screened before inclusion:

- **USA affiliation check** — each post's stated university/institution and location were verified against known US institutions; postings for non-US institutions surfaced by the same queries (e.g. Hong Kong, Portugal, France, Norway, Belgium, Italy, Netherlands, Switzerland, Australia, Bangladesh) were excluded.
- **Recency check** — LinkedIn shows only a relative post age (e.g. "3w", "5mo", "11mo", "1yr"), never an absolute date, so each post's age label was read directly to judge how current it was.
- **Field check** — each posting's department/lab description was read to classify it as STEM, STEM-adjacent, or MBA/Business for the summary sheet.
- **Duplicate check** — postings re-shared by multiple accounts were kept once, attributed to the original poster where identifiable.

3. Hashtags That Aid Discovery

The hashtags below appeared repeatedly on relevant PhD-recruitment and PhD-opportunity posts during this search. Searching or filtering by these directly (e.g.

[linkedin.com/search/results/content/?keywords=%23PhDposition](https://www.linkedin.com/search/results/content/?keywords=%23PhDposition)) is a fast way to surface similar content in future passes, and following them can also surface new posts in the LinkedIn feed over time.

General PhD recruitment

#PhD #PhDposition #PhDpositions #PhDstudent #PhDstudents #PhDopportunity #PhDrecruitment
#PhDadmissions #PhDapplication

Funding-related

#FullyFundedPhD #fullyfundedscholarship #PhDscholarship #GraduateFunding

Academia / career

#AcademicCareers #AcademicTwitter #DoctoralPrograms #GradSchool #HigherEducation
#ResearchCareers #NowHiring

Field-specific

#STEMcareers #ComputerScience #MachineLearning #DataScience #MarketingPhD #FinancePhD
#BusinessSchool #MBAprograms

Note: LinkedIn hashtag usage varies by poster and is not standardized, so these should be treated as the most commonly recurring tags observed in this batch rather than an exhaustive or official taxonomy.

Prepared for the USA University PhD LinkedIn Postings workbook · Search window: no fixed date limit ("Thorough" batch) · 50 postings across 41 universities.